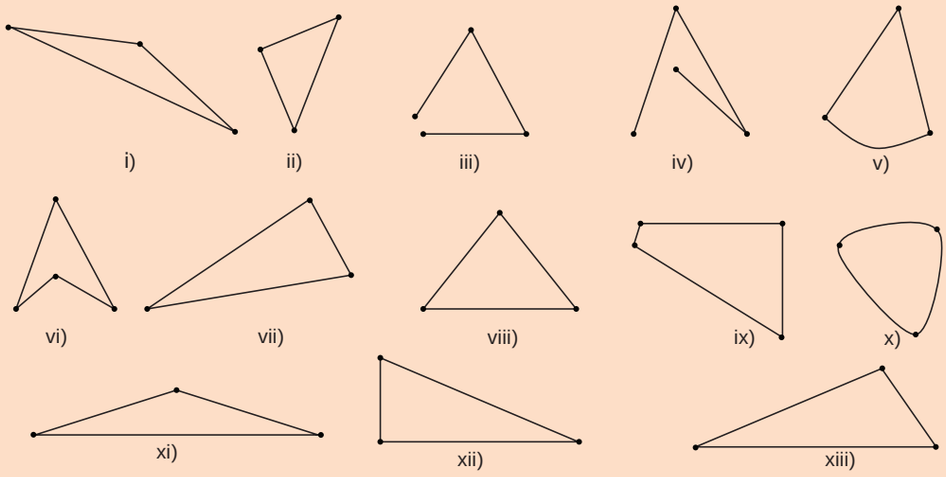
He is not able to create a closed figure. Do you know why? Can you guess the least number of sticks required to form a closed figure? Three sticks. If you had formed a closed figure with three sticks, then what shape would you get? Is there any special name for it? Yes. Its ***triangle.***

A closed figure formed by three line segments is called a triangle.

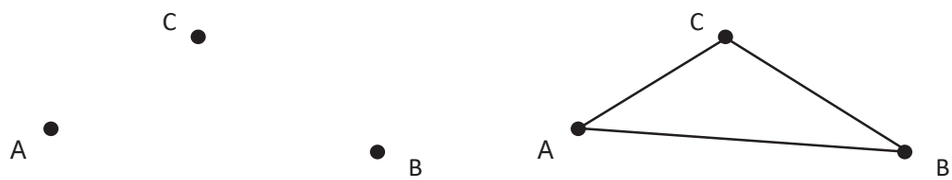
Activity

Classify the given shapes into triangles and non triangles.



4.2 Basic Elements of a Triangle

Mark 3 points A, B, C on a paper, such that they do not lie on a straight line. Join the line segments AB, BC and CA.

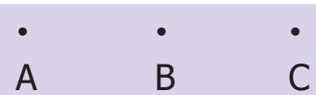


This forms a ***triangle ABC*** represented as ***Δ ABC or ΔBCA or ΔCAB.***

In Δ ABC, the line segments **AB, BC** and **CA** are called the ***sides of the triangle*** and ∠**CAB,** ∠**ABC** and ∠**BCA (**∠**A,** ∠**B &** ∠**C)** are called the ***angles of the triangle.*** The point of intersection of two sides of the triangle is called the ***vertex.*** **A, B** and **C** are ***three vertices of Δ ABC.*** Hence, ***a triangle has 3 sides, 3 angles and 3 vertices.***

Think

Can a triangle be drawn using 3 points on a straight line?



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